

Philipp Hilbert. *Technical Product Manager for governed AI systems.*

Positioning, ten years of AI platform and cross-functional product delivery, now focused on building verifiable identity and trust fabric for production AI deployments.

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§ WHY AFFINIDI

Affinidi is attacking the exact problem that makes enterprise AI adoption stall: organisations can build impressive proofs of concept but cannot safely put AI agents into production without verifiable identity, policy enforcement, and audit trails. The job description names that gap directly – moving from promising PoCs to secure, governed deployments – and that is precisely the territory I have been working in, first at Rohde & Schwarz on defence-grade AI data provenance and auditability, and earlier at Qcrypt AG where I owned a quantum-secure identity and encryption product from concept to customer. The Trust Fabric product suite combines decentralised identity, policy guardrails, and real-time observability into a single platform layer, which is a technically ambitious scope with clear enterprise pull. *That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not shipped a W3C Verifiable Credentials or DID-spec product directly. What I do bring is deep experience in the adjacent mechanics: secure data provenance, audit trails, identity management for regulated data pipelines, and quantum-resistant encryption product ownership – all of which map cleanly onto verifiable credential infrastructure problems.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, spec generation and edge-case exploration
 - **GPT**, research synthesis and user story drafting
 - **GitHub Copilot**, in-editor code review and implementation support
 - **Cursor / VSCode**, codebase navigation and refactoring
 - **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
 - **Framer**, design-heavy wireframing
 - **n8n**, multi-agent and agentic workflow automation
 - **Gamma.app**, structured stakeholder communication
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, AngularJS, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, Redpanda, Bitbucket, Git, MicroStrategy, CGM API integration, low-code insurance platform, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

QCRYPT AG [YOUTUBE.COM/WATCH?V=NT06F71LGFE](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NT06F71LGFE) →

Quantum-secure encryption product built on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware.

- Owned the full product architecture for backup, restore, checkpoint, and data-encryption modules from concept to customer.
- Designed for zero-technical-knowledge setup: functional under two minutes, no configuration required from the end user.
- Also served as deputy IT security officer, covering attack vector analysis and compliance governance.
- Directly relevant to Trust Fabric: the core design problem – making cryptographic identity usable at production scale without exposing implementation complexity to users – is the same challenge Affinidi faces with verifiable credential issuance and verification.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT AFFINIDI

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow engineering standups and read existing Trust Fabric specs, architecture decision records, and open issues to build a precise picture of where the product is, where the gaps are in the verifiable identity and policy guardrail flows, and which developer pain points are generating the most friction.

WEEK 2

Slice and structure.

Pick the single highest-ambiguity area identified in week one, decompose it into clear acceptance criteria and testable increments, and run a focused refinement session with engineering to validate feasibility and surface hidden constraints.

WEEK 3+

Ship and iterate.

Get the first incremental piece of that area into users' hands, instrument it for measurable outcomes, and begin the feedback loop that turns the Trust Fabric from a technically sound platform into a product developers actively choose to integrate.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Affinidi team,

The Trust Fabric problem statement you have written – giving AI agents verifiable identity, policy guardrails, and real-time observability so organisations can move from PoC to governed production – is one I recognise from the inside. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the AI data management platform for the FCAS defence programme, where the core product challenge was identical in structure: how do you make multimodal AI training data trustworthy enough that downstream decisions can be audited, reproduced, and defended to multinational stakeholders? The answer I built there – reproducible transformation pipelines, full data provenance, SafeAI and ExplainableAI evaluation concepts, and GitOps-based rollout – is the same class of thinking that Trust Fabric applies to agent identity and policy enforcement.

Earlier, as Product Owner at Qcrypt AG, I owned a quantum-secure encryption product where the design constraint was that users needed zero cryptographic knowledge to operate it. That constraint – making serious security infrastructure invisible to the person deploying it – is directly analogous to what a developer-facing verifiable credential product needs to achieve. I also served as deputy IT security officer during that period, which gave me a practical grounding in attack vectors, key management, and compliance governance that I have carried into every role since.

I am comfortable in the ambiguity you describe. At Emil Group I inherited a 17-person team that had lost sprint discipline, was hemorrhaging senior developers, and had broken trust with a key client. I split the team, reintroduced structured refinement, ran weekly product workshops directly with the client, and recovered the delivery track within two months. At the Federal Employment Agency I served simultaneously as Product Manager and Deputy IT Security Officer, owning both feature delivery and compliance governance for a public analytics platform serving regional labour market data. In both cases the challenge was the same one your posting names: take ownership of something that does not come with a playbook, bring structure, and maintain momentum while direction continues to evolve.

On the technical side, I can engage at the level your engineering team will expect. At Rohde & Schwarz I unblocked an infrastructure-level OpenShift issue independently and delivered a feature in one week that the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year. I work daily with AI-native tooling – Claude, GPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor – for spec generation, edge-case analysis, and implementation support. I understand how APIs, distributed systems, and identity flows are designed and where they fail in production.

Affinidi is building infrastructure that will matter. The ability to put governed, auditable AI agents into enterprise production is not a feature; it is what converts the current wave of AI investment from speculative to operational. I want to help build that, and I believe the combination of technical depth, delivery ownership, and security product experience I bring is a strong fit for the Senior Product Manager role on the Trust Fabric team.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Technical Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience shipping AI data platforms, analytics systems, secure identity products, and B2B SaaS in regulated environments. Comfortable owning ambiguous, high-stakes product areas where requirements are incomplete

and delivery pressure is constant. Brings hands-on technical depth – GitOps, distributed systems, API integration, security architecture – combined with structured discovery, strong stakeholder communication, and a founder's bias toward action over process. Particularly strong in developer-facing products where trust, auditability, and operational governance are first-class concerns.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- API and systems integration product ownership, end-to-end
 - AI data provenance, audit trails, and SafeAI evaluation concepts
 - Security product architecture and deputy IT security officer experience
 - Autonomous feature delivery from user story through GitOps rollout
 - Cross-functional alignment across engineering, compliance, and executive stakeholders
 - Backlog management, sprint discipline, and team restructuring under pressure
 - Developer workflow empathy and technical depth in distributed systems
 - Product discovery under ambiguity with structured problem decomposition
 - Founder-level pragmatism, low ego, high agency
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered reproducible data transformation pipelines with full data provenance and audit trails enabling SafeAI and ExplainableAI evaluation concepts for ML training datasets
- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout via ArgoCD
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Unblocked infrastructure-level OpenShift issues independently; delivered in one week a feature the project lead had been requesting from engineers for over a year
- Led cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA for a European defence programme (FCAS) with multinational stakeholders

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison features, and modernised admin tooling on the Arbeitsmarktmonitor platform
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with responsibility for compliance, governance, and data lineage across a public-sector analytics platform
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production on a B2B InsurTech platform reducing insurance product time-to-market from over one year to under one week
- Rebuilt sprint discipline and delivery stability: split a 17-person team into focused Scrum units, introduced ownership and deputy concepts, and reintroduced velocity tracking
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured weekly product workshops and transparent communication
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and document storage on iOS and Android
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows; managed complex external API and legacy database constraints transparently with stakeholders
- Led a small team under tight deadlines with strict prioritisation on highest-leverage features

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner, Quantum-Secure Encryption

- Owned full product architecture for backup, restore, checkpoint, and data-encryption modules; USP was zero-knowledge setup under two minutes

- Served as deputy IT security officer covering attack vector analysis, compliance governance, and key management

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder, CFO

- Built group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone: PSP integration, full UX/UI design, mobile app prototype; later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

BUNDESDRUCKEREI – COVID-19 DATA PLATFORM 2021, 2021

Product Owner

- RKI projects DIM and DESH: secure data structures and identity management for national health reporting infrastructure

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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